

STRAWBERRY DREAM SOCKS

NINE SIZES, 44 TO 92



Socks worked from the top down, with a green twisted rib, a ring of small strawberry tops, cream seeds, a proper heel flap with a turned heel and a wedge toe that is grafted. Graded in nine sizes, from small newborn up to two years.

44

small newborn / preemie

50

newborn, 0-1 mo

56

1-2 mo

62

2-4 mo

68

4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years



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Little Montessori Explorers

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Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. Test knit version 1.0

BEFORE YOU START

These are proper socks, not booties. They are worked in the round from the top down: first the green rib, then the ring of strawberry tops, then the pink leg with seeds. The work is then divided, and you knit the heel flap back and forth over half the stitches. The heel is turned with short rows, you pick up stitches along the flap, decrease the gusset back to the original stitch count, knit the foot and finish with a wedge toe that is grafted.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a slip stitch heel flap that stands up to wear
- turning a round heel with short rows
- picking up edge stitches and decreasing a gusset
- shaping a wedge toe and grafting it invisibly

DIFFICULTY

Slightly experienced. The heel turn is the only genuinely new thing here, and it is written out row by row with the numbers for your size. If you have never knitted a sock before, work the smallest size first: it is finished in an evening, and then you have the whole method in your hands.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The socks are graded in the same nine sizes as the rest of the collection, one sock per garment size. Measure the foot from heel to longest toe, and choose the size just above that measurement. The foot length is the measurement that decides whether a sock fits.

44

small newborn / preemie

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newborn, 0-1 mo

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4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years

Size	Foot length	Leg length	Stitches round	Circumference	Rib
44	7,0 cm	5,0 cm	24 sts	11,4 cm	2,5 cm
50	8,0 cm	5,5 cm	24 sts	11,4 cm	2,5 cm
56	9,0 cm	6,0 cm	28 sts	13,3 cm	3,0 cm
62	10,0 cm	6,5 cm	28 sts	13,3 cm	3,0 cm
68	11,0 cm	7,0 cm	32 sts	15,2 cm	3,5 cm
74	12,0 cm	7,5 cm	32 sts	15,2 cm	3,5 cm
80	13,0 cm	8,0 cm	32 sts	15,2 cm	4,0 cm
86	14,0 cm	8,5 cm	36 sts	17,1 cm	4,0 cm
92	15,0 cm	9,0 cm	36 sts	17,1 cm	4,0 cm

You will notice that some neighbouring sizes have the same stitch count round. They are not two identical sizes: a foot grows longer far faster than it grows wider, so the foot length, leg length, rib and heel flap all differ even where the circumference stands still. The circumference is also smaller than the foot is long, and it should be. A sock stays up because it stretches a little.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop, the rounds are small
Darning needle	for grafting the toe and weaving in ends
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round
Spare needle	to hold the instep stitches while the heel is worked

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
44	15 g	10 g	5 g
50	20 g	15 g	5 g
56	25 g	20 g	5 g
62	30 g	25 g	5 g
68	35 g	30 g	5 g
74	40 g	35 g	5 g
80	45 g	40 g	5 g
86	50 g	45 g	5 g
92	55 g	50 g	5 g

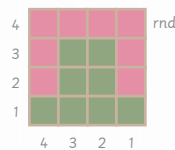
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

STRAWBERRY TOP AND SEEDS

The rounds are worked in the order they are numbered, round 1 first, and each round is read from right to left, the same way you knit. The strawberry top is 4 stitches and is repeated round. It is deliberately smaller than the leaf on the larger garments: on a mitten or a sock the large leaf would cover almost the whole surface.

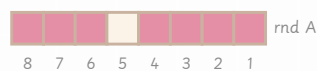
STRAWBERRY TOP, 4 STITCHES x 4 ROUNDS



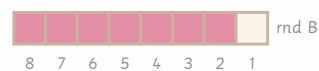
● leaf green ● strawberry pink ● cream white, one seed

SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches. On such a small area two seed rounds are enough: work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. The two rounds offset the seeds against each other.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • THE RIB AND THE RING

Cast on in green, join in the round without twisting the cast-on, and place a marker at the beginning of the round. Work twisted rib, that is *k1 through the back loop, p1*, until the rib measures the height in your column.

Size	Cast on	Rib	Points round	Height of the ring
44	24 sts	2,5 cm	6 x	1,4 cm
50	24 sts	2,5 cm	6 x	1,4 cm
56	28 sts	3,0 cm	7 x	1,4 cm
62	28 sts	3,0 cm	7 x	1,4 cm
68	32 sts	3,5 cm	8 x	1,4 cm
74	32 sts	3,5 cm	8 x	1,4 cm
80	32 sts	4,0 cm	8 x	1,4 cm
86	36 sts	4,0 cm	9 x	1,4 cm
92	36 sts	4,0 cm	9 x	1,4 cm

THE RING OF STRAWBERRY TOPS

Work the strawberry top from page 5 over 4 stitches and repeat it round as many times as your column says. The sock is worked from the top down, so the points face downwards towards the foot, just like the calyx on a strawberry. Change to pink after the last chart round.

2 • THE LEG AND THE SEEDS

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round until the leg measures the height in your column, measured from the ring. Along the way you work two seed rounds. On a seed round you work *1 cream, the rest pink*, where the repeat is the stitch count in your column. Work 4 rounds in pink, then work the second seed round offset by half the repeat, so the seeds do not sit in vertical columns.

Size	Stitches	Leg in pink	Seed repeat	Seeds per round
44	24 sts	5,0 cm	8 sts	3 x
50	24 sts	5,5 cm	8 sts	3 x
56	28 sts	6,0 cm	7 sts	4 x
62	28 sts	6,5 cm	7 sts	4 x
68	32 sts	7,0 cm	8 sts	4 x
74	32 sts	7,5 cm	8 sts	4 x
80	32 sts	8,0 cm	8 sts	4 x
86	36 sts	8,5 cm	9 sts	4 x
92	36 sts	9,0 cm	9 sts	4 x

The socks have their own seed repeat, and it is not 8 stitches as elsewhere in the collection. A sock must sit close, and with only multiples of 8 the circumference jumps from 11.4 to 15.2 cm. The repeat in your column divides exactly into your stitch count, so you do not have to calculate.

3 • THE HEEL FLAP

Divide the work: put half the stitches on a spare needle, that is the instep, and continue back and forth over the other half, that is the heel. The heel flap is worked like this: the right side is *slip 1 with the yarn behind, k1*, repeated to the end of the row. The wrong side is slip 1 with the yarn in front, then purl to the end. Repeat these two rows until you have worked as many rows as your column says. End with a wrong side row.

Size	Heel stitches	Instep stitches	Rows in the flap	Edge stitches each side
44	12 sts	12 sts	12 x	6 sts
50	12 sts	12 sts	12 x	6 sts
56	14 sts	14 sts	14 x	7 sts
62	14 sts	14 sts	14 x	7 sts
68	16 sts	16 sts	16 x	8 sts
74	16 sts	16 sts	16 x	8 sts
80	16 sts	16 sts	16 x	8 sts
86	18 sts	18 sts	18 x	9 sts
92	18 sts	18 sts	18 x	9 sts

The slipped stitches make the flap twice as dense as stocking stitch. That is where a sock wears through first, and it is the whole reason a heel flap is worth the extra rows. The slipped stitch at the start of each row also creates a chain along the sides, and that is what you pick the stitches up from afterwards.

4 • TURNING THE HEEL

The heel is turned with short rows. Read the numbers in your column into the rows below.

- Row 1, right side: slip 1, knit the number your column gives, ssk, k1, turn the work.
- Row 2, wrong side: slip 1, purl the number your column gives, p2tog, p1, turn the work.
- Row 3: slip 1, knit to 1 stitch before the gap, ssk across the gap, k1, turn.
- Row 4: slip 1, purl to 1 stitch before the gap, p2tog across the gap, p1, turn.
- Repeat rows 3 and 4 until all the stitches have been taken in. On the last two rows there is not always a stitch left for the final knit or purl, and then you simply turn right after the decrease.

Size	Heel stitches	Row 1: knit after slipped st	Row 2: purl after slipped st	Turns	Left after turning
44	12 sts	6 sts	3 sts	4 x	8 sts
50	12 sts	6 sts	3 sts	4 x	8 sts
56	14 sts	7 sts	3 sts	6 x	8 sts
62	14 sts	7 sts	3 sts	6 x	8 sts
68	16 sts	8 sts	3 sts	6 x	10 sts
74	16 sts	8 sts	3 sts	6 x	10 sts
80	16 sts	8 sts	3 sts	6 x	10 sts
86	18 sts	9 sts	3 sts	8 x	10 sts
92	18 sts	9 sts	3 sts	8 x	10 sts

5 • THE GUSSET

Now you join the work back into a round. Knit across the heel stitches, pick up and knit the number of edge stitches your column gives along one side of the heel flap, knit the instep stitches from the spare needle, and pick up the same number of edge stitches along the other side. You now have the high stitch count in your column. Then decrease like this: on each decrease round you ssk just before the instep and k2tog just after the instep, that is 2 stitches decreased. Work 1 round in knit between each decrease round, until you are back at the stitch count the sock had in the leg.

Size	After the heel	Pick up each side	Stitches in all	Decrease rounds	Back to
44	8 sts	6 sts	32 sts	4 x	24 sts
50	8 sts	6 sts	32 sts	4 x	24 sts
56	8 sts	7 sts	36 sts	4 x	28 sts
62	8 sts	7 sts	36 sts	4 x	28 sts
68	10 sts	8 sts	42 sts	5 x	32 sts
74	10 sts	8 sts	42 sts	5 x	32 sts
80	10 sts	8 sts	42 sts	5 x	32 sts
86	10 sts	9 sts	46 sts	5 x	36 sts
92	10 sts	9 sts	46 sts	5 x	36 sts

Pick the stitches up through both strands of the chain along the flap, not just the outer one. That gives a tighter join, and this is where socks most often get holes.

6 • THE FOOT AND THE TOE

THE FOOT

Knit round until the foot measures the length in your column, measured from the very back of the heel. You may work one more seed round over the instep along the way.

THE WEDGE TOE

Divide the round into two equal halves, the top and the sole. On each decrease round you decrease 2 stitches in each half: ssk at the start of the half and k2tog at the end, that is 4 stitches decreased in all. Work 1 round in knit between each decrease round. Repeat until you have the stitches in your column left. Cut the yarn, and graft the two halves together with a darning needle.

Size	Stitches	Foot before the toe	Decrease rounds	Left for grafting
44	24 sts	4,9 cm	3 x	12 sts
50	24 sts	5,9 cm	3 x	12 sts
56	28 sts	6,1 cm	4 x	12 sts
62	28 sts	7,1 cm	4 x	12 sts
68	32 sts	7,4 cm	5 x	12 sts
74	32 sts	8,4 cm	5 x	12 sts
80	32 sts	9,4 cm	5 x	12 sts
86	36 sts	10,4 cm	5 x	16 sts
92	36 sts	11,4 cm	5 x	16 sts

Grafting gives a completely flat join. A cast off toe leaves a ridge right across the toes, and that can be felt through a thin baby sock.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the the socks is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Chest after washing

Time taken, roughly

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Total length after washing

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Socks for the very smallest must not have a tight rib. Check that the rib does not leave marks round the ankle.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless, with a leaf yoke and flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper, with a round yoke and long sleeves.
- Strawberry Dream skirt, with a green rib at the waist and a scalloped hem.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream hat, with a calyx and ear flaps, sizes 44 to 92.
- Strawberry Dream socks, with a heel flap and wedge toe, sizes 44 to 92.

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